

ShopEase Customer Policy Handbook

Version 1.0 | Effective Date: 21 September 2026

A comprehensive customer-facing policy reference for an e-commerce platform

This handbook defines the standard policies, procedures, customer responsibilities, and service commitments of ShopEase. It is designed as a fictional reference document for developing and evaluating a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) chatbot.

Document Owner	ShopEase Customer Experience Team
Document Type	Customer Policy Handbook
Version	1.0
Effective Date	21 September 2026
Review Cycle	Every six months or when a policy changes
Intended Use	Customer support, internal operations, and RAG experimentation

Important Notice: ShopEase and all policies in this document are fictional and created for software development, testing, and educational purposes. They do not represent the policies of an actual company.

Document Overview

This handbook is organized into independent policy sections. Each section is written with explicit rules, conditions, timelines, and exceptions to make the content suitable for semantic retrieval and policy-based question answering.

Core Service Principles

- Provide customers with clear and understandable information before and after purchase.
- Apply published policies consistently while reviewing exceptional circumstances fairly.
- Protect customer information and use it only for legitimate business purposes.
- Communicate order, delivery, cancellation, return, and refund status promptly.
- Avoid making promises that are not supported by the applicable policy.
- Escalate disputes, suspected fraud, and unusual cases to the appropriate support team.

Policy Interpretation Rules

1. The most recent approved version of a policy takes precedence over older versions.
2. Product-specific terms may apply when they are displayed on the product page or invoice.
3. If two policy provisions appear to conflict, the customer support team must escalate the case before making a final commitment.
4. A support agent must verify order details before sharing account-specific information.
5. Policy exceptions require documented approval from an authorized supervisor.

Quick Reference: Standard Timeframes

Activity	Standard timeframe
Order confirmation	Usually within 10 minutes of successful payment
Order cancellation request	Before shipment dispatch
Standard return request	Within 7 calendar days of delivery
Refund initiation after approval	Within 2 business days
Bank/card refund visibility	Usually 5–7 business days, depending on provider
Customer support first response	Within 24 business hours

1. Customer Account Policy

1.1 Account Creation

Customers may create a ShopEase account using a valid email address or mobile number. Customers must provide accurate information and are responsible for maintaining the confidentiality of their login credentials.

- One individual should not create multiple accounts to misuse promotional benefits.
- Customers must not use another person's identity or payment credentials without authorization.
- ShopEase may request additional verification when unusual account activity is detected.
- A customer may browse products without an account, but certain services require sign-in.

1.2 Account Security

Customers should use a strong, unique password and avoid sharing one-time passwords, passwords, or authentication links. ShopEase support representatives will not request a customer's full password.

- Report suspected unauthorized access as soon as possible.
- Change the password immediately if account compromise is suspected.
- Do not share OTPs with callers, messages, or third parties claiming to represent ShopEase.
- Customers are responsible for reviewing account activity and saved addresses.

1.3 Account Suspension and Closure

ShopEase may temporarily restrict or close an account where there is credible evidence of fraud, abusive behavior, repeated policy manipulation, unlawful activity, or threats to platform security. Customers may request a review through customer support.

1.4 Customer Responsibilities

- Keep contact information updated.
- Use accurate delivery and billing details.
- Review order summaries before completing payment.
- Cooperate with reasonable verification requests.
- Avoid abusive, discriminatory, threatening, or harassing communication.

2. Product Browsing and Ordering Policy

2.1 Product Information

ShopEase attempts to display accurate product titles, descriptions, images, specifications, prices, and availability. Minor differences in color, packaging, measurements, or appearance may occur because of screen settings, manufacturing variations, or updated packaging.

2.2 Product Availability

- Products shown as available may become unavailable before an order is completed.
- Adding an item to a cart does not reserve inventory.
- An order is confirmed only after the platform generates an order confirmation.
- ShopEase may cancel an order when inventory information is materially incorrect.

2.3 Order Placement

6. Select the product and applicable quantity.
7. Review product specifications, seller information, delivery estimate, and price.
8. Enter or select the delivery address.
9. Choose an available payment method.
10. Review the final order summary, including delivery charges and discounts.
11. Submit payment or place the order using the selected payment method.
12. Retain the order confirmation for future reference.

2.4 Pricing Errors

If a clear pricing or catalog error is identified, ShopEase may contact the customer before dispatch. The customer may be offered the option to proceed at the corrected price or cancel the order. If payment was already captured and the order is cancelled, the applicable refund process will be initiated.

2.5 Quantity Restrictions

ShopEase may limit quantities for high-demand products, promotional products, or products subject to supply constraints. Orders that appear to bypass such restrictions may be reviewed or cancelled.

3. Payment Policy

3.1 Accepted Payment Methods

Depending on location and product eligibility, ShopEase may support credit cards, debit cards, net banking, UPI, selected digital wallets, cash on delivery, and other payment methods displayed at checkout.

3.2 Payment Authorization

- A payment authorization does not always mean that an order has been dispatched.
- The payment provider may temporarily place a hold on funds.
- Failed, reversed, or pending payments may require confirmation from the payment provider.
- Customers should not attempt repeated payments if the first transaction is still processing.

3.3 Cash on Delivery

Cash on delivery may be available only for eligible products, addresses, and order values. Customers should keep the required amount ready and inspect the package for visible external damage before accepting it where inspection is permitted.

3.4 Failed or Duplicate Payments

If a customer is charged more than once for one order, the customer should contact support with transaction references. ShopEase will investigate payment records and coordinate with the payment provider. Duplicate authorizations that were not captured may be released automatically according to the provider's timeline.

3.5 Payment Security

- ShopEase does not ask customers to share full card numbers, PINs, passwords, or OTPs through chat.
- Payment details are processed through authorized payment partners where applicable.
- Customers should complete payments only through official ShopEase checkout channels.
- Requests to transfer money to an individual employee account should be treated as suspicious.

4. Shipping and Delivery Policy

4.1 Delivery Estimates

Delivery estimates are calculated using inventory location, destination, carrier capacity, serviceability, weather, public holidays, and other operational factors. An estimate is not an unconditional guarantee.

Delivery category	Typical estimate
Metro standard delivery	2–5 business days
Non-metro standard delivery	4–8 business days
Express delivery, where available	1–2 business days
Remote or special service areas	7–12 business days

4.2 Dispatch and Tracking

- Customers receive a dispatch notification when the order is handed to the carrier.
- Tracking information may take up to 24 hours to show movement.
- A tracking status of 'label created' does not necessarily mean the parcel has begun transit.
- Customers should use the tracking link supplied in official ShopEase communications.

4.3 Delivery Attempts

Carriers may make up to three delivery attempts, depending on local operating procedures. Customers should ensure that the address, phone number, and recipient availability are correct. A parcel may be returned to the seller after unsuccessful attempts or prolonged non-collection.

4.4 Delayed Delivery

When delivery exceeds the estimated window, customers may contact support for a tracking review. ShopEase may coordinate with the carrier, provide an updated estimate, or offer an eligible resolution when a shipment is confirmed lost.

4.5 Address Changes

Address changes can generally be requested only before dispatch. After dispatch, customers may contact support, but changes are subject to carrier capability and may not be possible.

5. Order Cancellation Policy

5.1 Customer-Initiated Cancellation

Customers may request cancellation through the order page or customer support before the order is dispatched. Cancellation is not guaranteed after dispatch, handover to a carrier, or preparation for final delivery.

5.2 Cancellation Process

13. Open the order details page.
14. Select the cancellation option if it is available.
15. Choose a cancellation reason.
16. Confirm the request.
17. Review the cancellation status and any refund information.

5.3 Cancellation After Dispatch

If an order has already been dispatched, the customer may need to refuse delivery or initiate a return after receipt, subject to product eligibility. Customers should not open or use products when they intend to request a return for an issue that requires unused condition.

5.4 ShopEase-Initiated Cancellation

- The product is unavailable or inventory information is incorrect.
- The delivery address is not serviceable.
- Payment verification fails or payment is not received.
- The order appears fraudulent or violates quantity restrictions.
- A legal, safety, or operational issue prevents fulfillment.

5.5 Refund Following Cancellation

When cancellation is approved after payment capture, the refund is initiated according to the payment method and applicable refund policy. The time taken for funds to appear may vary by bank or payment provider.

6. Returns and Replacement Policy

6.1 General Return Window

Eligible products may be returned within 7 calendar days of delivery. The return window begins on the date the carrier records delivery. Some categories may have shorter windows, longer windows, or no return eligibility, as displayed on the product page.

6.2 Basic Eligibility Conditions

- The return request must be submitted within the stated return window.
- The product should be unused unless the claim concerns a defect or damage.
- Original packaging, accessories, manuals, tags, and invoices should be retained where applicable.
- The product must not show customer-caused damage, misuse, or unauthorized modification.
- The reason selected in the return request must accurately describe the issue.

6.3 Replacement Instead of Refund

For eligible products, customers may be offered a replacement when the item is defective, damaged, incomplete, or materially different from the listing. Replacement depends on inventory availability and verification of the reported issue.

6.4 Non-Returnable Categories

- Personalized or customized products, unless defective or incorrectly produced.
- Products that cannot be resold for hygiene or safety reasons, where legally and operationally applicable.
- Digital products or downloadable services after access has been used, unless otherwise specified.
- Gift cards or vouchers, except where required by applicable law or platform policy.
- Products damaged through misuse, improper storage, or unauthorized repair.

6.5 Return Inspection

Returned items may be inspected to verify the reported reason, product identity, accessories, serial number, and condition. Inspection does not automatically guarantee approval; the final decision depends on the applicable policy and evidence.

7. Refund Policy

7.1 Refund Eligibility

A refund may be issued after an eligible cancellation, approved return, failed fulfillment, confirmed lost shipment, duplicate payment, or other approved resolution. Refund eligibility is determined by the order status, product category, payment status, and applicable policy.

7.2 Refund Processing Stages

18. Customer submits a cancellation, return, or refund request.
19. ShopEase verifies the order and reason.
20. The product may be collected or inspected where required.
21. The request is approved, rejected, or escalated.
22. The refund is initiated to the original payment method when possible.
23. The customer receives a refund confirmation or status update.

7.3 Standard Refund Timeline

Stage	Expected timeline
Refund decision after required verification	Usually within 2 business days
Refund initiation after approval	Usually within 2 business days
Card or bank account visibility	Usually 5–7 business days
Wallet or platform balance	Usually within 24 hours after initiation
Cash-on-delivery refund	Usually 5–10 business days after bank details verification

7.4 Partial Refunds

A partial refund may apply where only part of an order is cancelled, one item in a bundle is unavailable, a price adjustment is approved, or a documented issue affects only part of the purchase. Delivery charges and promotional discounts may be recalculated according to the order terms.

7.5 Refund Delays

If the refund status shows 'processed' but the funds are not visible, customers should wait for the stated provider timeline and then contact support with the refund reference number. ShopEase may request a bank or payment provider trace.

8. Damaged, Defective, or Incorrect Products

8.1 Reporting Timeframe

Customers should report visible transit damage, missing components, incorrect products, or major defects as soon as possible and preferably within 48 hours of delivery. Reports after this period may still be reviewed, but additional evidence may be required.

8.2 Evidence Requirements

- Clear photographs of the outer packaging and product.
- A photograph of the shipping label where available.
- A description of the issue and when it was discovered.
- A short video when the issue involves operation or functionality.
- Information about missing accessories, parts, or documentation.

8.3 Incorrect Product

If a customer receives a different product, size, model, color, or quantity from the confirmed order, ShopEase will review the order record and arrange an eligible replacement, return, or refund.

8.4 Defective Product

A product may be classified as defective when it fails to perform its advertised basic function under normal intended use. Troubleshooting may be requested for technical products, provided that troubleshooting does not create a safety risk.

8.5 Safety-Related Issues

Customers should stop using a product if it presents a possible safety hazard, overheating, electrical fault, leakage, or other dangerous condition. Customers should keep the product away from children and contact ShopEase support for instructions. Customers should not attempt unauthorized repairs.

9. Warranty and Seller Support Policy

9.1 Warranty Coverage

Warranty coverage depends on the manufacturer, seller, product category, and terms shown at the time of purchase. Warranty coverage may include repair, replacement, or another remedy specified by the warranty provider.

9.2 Warranty Exclusions

- Normal wear and tear.
- Damage caused by accidents, misuse, or improper installation.
- Damage caused by unauthorized modifications or repairs.
- Consumable components that are designed to be replaced periodically.
- Issues caused by use outside the manufacturer's stated specifications.

9.3 Warranty Claim Process

24. Contact ShopEase support or the authorized warranty provider.
25. Provide the order number, product details, and a description of the issue.
26. Submit requested photographs, videos, or diagnostic information.
27. Follow approved inspection, pickup, or service instructions.
28. Retain service receipts and communication records.

9.4 Seller-Specific Terms

Products sold by third-party sellers may be subject to seller-specific service commitments. Where seller terms differ from ShopEase's general terms, the product page, invoice, and applicable legal requirements should be reviewed.

9.5 Service Completion

Warranty service timelines vary by product and provider. ShopEase may communicate an estimated service period but cannot guarantee a specific repair completion date when the process depends on a manufacturer or external service center.

10. Discounts, Coupons, and Promotional Offers

10.1 Coupon Usage

- Coupons must be used before their stated expiry date.
- A coupon may require a minimum cart value or specific product eligibility.
- Some coupons may be limited to one use per customer or account.
- Coupons cannot be exchanged for cash unless expressly stated.
- Coupons may not be combined unless the offer specifically permits stacking.

10.2 Promotional Pricing

Promotional prices may be available for a limited period or while inventory lasts. ShopEase may correct obvious technical or pricing errors. A promotion may exclude delivery fees, taxes, or selected products, as stated in the offer terms.

10.3 Misuse of Offers

ShopEase may cancel or reverse promotional benefits obtained through multiple accounts, automated abuse, manipulated transactions, false information, or other prohibited activity.

10.4 Refunds Involving Discounts

When an order using a coupon is partially cancelled or returned, the refund may reflect the allocation of the discount across eligible items. The amount refunded may not equal the original item price if a conditional discount is no longer applicable.

10.5 Referral Programs

Referral rewards are issued only when the qualifying conditions are met. Self-referrals, duplicate accounts, fraudulent activity, and transactions that are cancelled or refunded may not qualify.

11. Privacy and Data Protection Policy

11.1 Information Collected

ShopEase may collect information required to provide services, such as contact details, delivery addresses, order history, payment status, support communications, device information, and usage data. The categories collected depend on the service used.

11.2 Use of Information

- Process orders, payments, deliveries, returns, and refunds.
- Respond to customer support requests.
- Prevent fraud, abuse, and unauthorized account access.
- Improve website performance, product discovery, and customer experience.
- Send service-related notifications and, where permitted, marketing communications.

11.3 Data Minimization

Employees and support agents should access only the information necessary for their assigned task. Sensitive information must not be copied into unsecured documents, personal messaging applications, or unauthorized systems.

11.4 Customer Rights and Requests

Subject to applicable law and operational requirements, customers may request access, correction, deletion, or clarification regarding their personal information. Requests may require identity verification to protect the account holder.

11.5 Data Retention

ShopEase retains information only for as long as reasonably required for service delivery, legal compliance, dispute resolution, fraud prevention, accounting, and legitimate operational purposes.

11.6 Security Incidents

If ShopEase identifies a suspected data security incident, it will follow its internal incident response procedures, assess the impact, restrict unauthorized access, and provide legally required notifications.

12. Customer Support and Complaints

12.1 Support Channels

Customers may contact ShopEase through the official help center, in-app support, registered email, or other channels listed on the official website. Customers should avoid sharing confidential information through unofficial channels.

12.2 First Response Commitment

ShopEase aims to provide an initial response within 24 business hours. Complex cases involving carriers, sellers, payment providers, or technical investigations may require additional time.

12.3 Information to Include

- Order number or registered contact detail.
- A concise description of the issue.
- Relevant dates and previous support reference numbers.
- Photographs, screenshots, or documents when requested.
- The resolution being requested, such as replacement, refund, or status update.

12.4 Escalation

A case may be escalated when it remains unresolved after standard support review, involves repeated delivery failures, concerns a safety issue, includes a payment dispute, or requires supervisor approval for an exception.

12.5 Customer Conduct

Customers are expected to communicate respectfully. Threats, harassment, discriminatory language, impersonation, and repeated abusive contacts may lead to restricted communication channels or account review.

12.6 Complaint Resolution

29. Support records the complaint and verifies the relevant order.
30. The case is categorized and assigned to the appropriate team.
31. The team investigates available records and requests evidence if necessary.
32. The customer receives the decision, next steps, or an estimated review timeline.
33. The case is closed after resolution or after reasonable follow-up attempts.

13. Fraud Prevention and Acceptable Use

13.1 Prohibited Activities

- Using stolen payment methods or another person's account without authorization.
- Creating multiple accounts to obtain unauthorized promotional benefits.
- Submitting false claims about non-delivery, damage, or missing items.
- Manipulating reviews, ratings, or seller communications.
- Using bots or automated tools to disrupt services or bypass purchase limits.
- Attempting to access systems, accounts, or data without authorization.

13.2 Fraud Review

ShopEase may place an order on hold while reviewing unusual payment patterns, inconsistent identity information, suspicious delivery addresses, repeated claims, or other risk indicators. A review may delay processing.

13.3 Customer Cooperation

Customers may be asked to confirm selected information or provide documentation. ShopEase will not request a customer's password, full payment PIN, or one-time password.

13.4 Consequences

Where evidence supports a violation, ShopEase may cancel orders, reverse unauthorized benefits, restrict account functionality, suspend accounts, or refer matters to relevant authorities where appropriate.

13.5 False Claims

A customer who knowingly submits false or misleading information may lose eligibility for certain services and may be responsible for resulting costs, subject to applicable law.

14. Frequently Asked Questions

Can I cancel my order after placing it?

You can request cancellation before dispatch. After dispatch, cancellation may not be available and you may need to refuse delivery or submit an eligible return request.

How long do refunds take?

Refund initiation usually occurs within two business days after approval. The time for funds to appear depends on the payment provider and is commonly five to seven business days for cards or bank accounts.

Can I return every product?

No. Return eligibility depends on product category, condition, time window, and the terms shown on the product page.

What should I do if my package is damaged?

Take photographs of the packaging and product, avoid using the item if it may be unsafe, and report the issue as soon as possible, preferably within 48 hours.

Can I change my delivery address?

Address changes are generally possible only before dispatch and are subject to serviceability and operational constraints.

Why is my tracking information not moving?

Tracking updates may take up to 24 hours after dispatch. If the shipment remains unchanged beyond the estimated window, contact support for a review.

What if I receive the wrong product?

Contact support with the order details and photographs. ShopEase will review the mismatch and arrange an eligible replacement, return, or refund.

Can I use more than one coupon?

Only when the promotional terms allow coupon stacking. Otherwise, the system may accept only one applicable coupon.

Does ShopEase ask for OTPs?

No. Customers should never share OTPs, passwords, PINs, or full payment credentials with support representatives or other callers.

How do I escalate a complaint?

Provide your existing support reference number and request escalation when the issue remains unresolved or requires supervisor review.

What happens if a product is out of stock after payment?

ShopEase may cancel the order and initiate a refund according to the payment method and refund timeline.

Can I return a used product?

Used products are generally not eligible for standard returns, but defective, damaged, or incorrect products may be reviewed under the applicable exception process.

Appendix A: Policy Decision Matrix

Customer Situation	Initial Action	Possible Resolution
Order not dispatched	Verify cancellation eligibility	Cancel and refund if payment was captured
Order dispatched but not delivered	Check carrier tracking	Carrier escalation, updated estimate, or lost-shipment review
Wrong product received	Verify order and evidence	Replacement, return, or refund
Product damaged in transit	Request photographs and delivery details	Replacement, return, or refund after review
Duplicate payment	Check payment transaction records	Refund duplicate captured amount
Coupon not applying	Check eligibility and expiry	Explain terms or escalate technical issue
Account suspected compromised	Verify identity and restrict access if needed	Password reset and security review
Refund marked processed but not received	Check refund reference and provider timeline	Payment trace or provider escalation

Appendix B: RAG Metadata Suggestions

For RAG ingestion, each section can be split into chunks while preserving the following metadata fields:

- document_name: ShopEase Customer Policy Handbook
- document_version: 1.0
- effective_date: 2026-09-21
- section_title: the relevant policy section
- policy_category: returns, refunds, shipping, payment, account, or support
- audience: customer
- priority: standard or escalation-required
- source_type: fictional business policy

Recommended Chunking Approach

34. Split content by major section and subsection headings.
35. Use chunk sizes that preserve complete rules and exceptions.
36. Store section title and policy category as metadata.
37. Avoid splitting a timeline table from the explanatory paragraph that defines it.
38. Create evaluation questions for both direct fact retrieval and exception handling.
39. Test whether the chatbot refuses to invent a policy when the document does not provide an answer.

Appendix C: Example RAG Evaluation Questions

- How many days do customers have to request a standard return?
- What should a customer do if the product arrives damaged?
- Can a customer cancel an order after dispatch?
- What is the typical refund visibility period for a bank refund?
- Does ShopEase support cash on delivery for every product?
- What information should never be shared with customer support?
- When should a delivery delay be escalated?
- What are the conditions for coupon usage?
- What happens when a product is unavailable after payment?
- Which cases require supervisor approval?

End of Document. This fictional handbook is intended for RAG development, retrieval testing, chatbot grounding, and policy-based response evaluation.